engineer, an administrator, a technology manager al rol ed into one—what more could I have asked for?

We flew in an Avro aircraft which took around ninety minutes from Madras to Trivandrum. von Braun asked me about our work and listened as if he was just another student of rocketry. I never expected the father of modern rocketry to be so humble, receptive and encouraging. He made me feel comfortable right through the flight. It was hard to imagine that I was talking to a giant of missile systems, as he was so self-effacing.

He observed that the length to diameter L/D ratio of the SLV3, which was designed to be 22 was on the higher side and cautioned me about the aero-elastic problems which must be avoided during flight.

Having spent the major part of his working life in Germany, how did he feel in America? I asked this of von Braun who had become a cult figure in the States after creating the Saturn rocket in the Apol o mission which put man on the moon. “America is a country of great possibilities, but they look upon everything un-American with suspicion and contempt. They suffer from a deep-rooted NIH—Not Invented Here—complex and look down